Unit - 1 D - 9/11/2026

Introduction to Environmental Studies.

1. Define Environmental Studies.

Ans. Environmental studies is a field of study that looks at the relationship between humans and their surroundings, which include, air, water, land, plants, animals, and even things like buildings and technology. The word "Environment" comes from the French word "environ", meaning surroundings.

According to the Environmental Protection Act (1986), the environment is "the sum total of water, air and land, along with the interrelationships among themselves and with human beings, other living beings and property."

Environmental studies is multidisciplinary, involving different branches such as biology, chemistry, physics, medical science and, agriculture, and social sciences. It aims to find practical solutions for making human life sustainable and to ensure that we use resources wisely so future generations can live well, too.

2. Why is Environmental Studies called multidisciplinary in nature?

Ans Environmental studies is called multidisciplinary because it includes knowledge and principles from many different subjects. For example, it uses biology to understand living organisms,

chemistry to study air and water pollution, physics to study energy use, and even social sciences to analyze how people affect and ~~see~~ are affected by the environment. Medical sciences, agriculture, economics, and public health are also involved.

This means that environmental studies does not look at problems from just one angle - it brings together ideas from all these fields to understand complex issues, such as pollution, resource management, and global warming. By being multidisciplinary, the field can offer complete solutions that consider science, society, health and economies together.

3. What is the scope of Environmental Studies?

Ans. The scope of Environmental Studies is very broad, covering many topics and fields. Some important areas include:

- Ecology: Studies the relationships between living organisms - including humans - and their environments. It includes topics like food chains, ecosystems, biodiversity and conservation.

- Environmental Science: Focuses on understanding problems such as climate change, air and water pollution, and resource management using scientific methods.

- Pollution control and Environmental Health: Examines how pollution affects human health and what can be done to prevent it.
- Resource management: Involves managing water, land, minerals, and other natural resources to ensure they are not wasted or destroyed.
- Environmental Policy and law: Deals with making and enforcing rules to protect the environment.
- Sustainability: Studies how to use resources and develop societies in ways that do not harm the environment or run out of resources for the future.
- Environmental Education: Spreads awareness about environmental issues through teaching and community programs.
- Climate change: Looks at how weather patterns are changing and how these changes impacts humans and ecosystems.
- Urban and Regional Planning: Involves designing cities and regions to minimize negative impact on the environment.
- Human-Environment Interaction: Explores how our actions impact the environment, and how changes in the environment, in turn, impact us.

4. Discuss the importance of Environmental Studies.

Environmental studies is important for many reasons:

- Understanding Environmental Issues: It helps us understand complex issues like air, and water pollution, climate change, deforestation and loss of biodiversity.
- Promoting sustainability: Students learn about managing natural resources (like water and forests) in a way that meets current needs without harming the ability of future generations to meet their needs.
- Protecting Ecosystems: It highlights why it important to conserve ecosystems and endangered species for the balance of nature.
- Public Health: Studies shows how pollution can cause diseases, so it helps develop ways to reduce health risks and promote better living standards.
- Guiding Policies: Provides scientific facts that help governments create effective laws and regulations for environmental protection.
- Fostering Stewardship: Encourages individuals and communities to take responsibility for the environment through education and participation.

- Economic Benefits - Promotes innovation in green technology and energy-saving practices, which can save money and create jobs.

- Solving Global Problems - Helps find worldwide solutions to big challenges like global warming and pollution that affect everyone.

- Critical Thinking : Encourages ~~combining~~ combining knowledge from science, technology, and economics, and social science to solve problems in new ways.

5. What is sustainability in Environmental Studies?

Ans. Sustainability means using resources in such a way that we meet our present needs without making it hard for future generations to meet theirs. It focuses on maintaining the balance of natural resources, preserving ecosystems, and avoiding actions that could damage the environment for those who come after us.

For example, if we cut down trees for wood, sustainability means planting new trees to replace them. It is about protecting the earth's health and using resources wisely so both people alive now and those born in the future can have a clean, safe and healthy planet to live on.

6. What is Sustainable Development?

Ans. Sustainable Development is a way of progress-ing or developing (like building houses and factories, or growing food) that does not harm the environment or use up resources needed by future generations. It combines economic growth, environmental protection, and social well-being.

The most common definition comes from the Brundtland commision in 1987:

"Development that meets the needs of the present generation without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs." This approach tries to balance the right to improve our lives and the need to protect the environment for the future.

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7. What are the principles of sustainable Developm-ent?

Ans Some main principles are:

- Intergenerational Equity: Use resources with future generations in mind.

- Intragenerational Equity: Share resources fairly among people living today, without big gaps in who benefits.

- Conservation of Biodiversity: Protect all forms of life and their habitats.

- Precautionary Principle: Take action to prevent harm to the environment, even if all the risks aren't fully known.

- Polluter Pays principle: Those who cause damage to the environment should pay for fixing it.

- Integration- Make decisions by thinking about environmental protection, economic growth, and social needs together.

- Public Participation- Involve everyone in making decisions about the environment.

- Sustainable use of Resources - Use resources carefully and avoid waste, so they'll last for the future.

8. What are Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)? Name four.

Ans. The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) are 17 global goals set up by the United nations in 2015 as a part of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. They aim to address issues like poverty, hunger, health, education, clean water, climate action and peace.

four examples are -

1. SDG 1: No Poverty - Eradicate extreme poverty for all people.

2. SDG 2: Zero Hunger - End hunger and encourage

sustainable farming.

3. SDG 3: Good Health and Well-Being: Make sure everyone has the chance to live healthy lives.

4. SDG 7: Affordable and Clean Energy: Make clean and affordable energy available to everyone.

9. Write a short note on Low carbon lifestyle.

Ans: A low-carbon lifestyle aims to reduce the amount of carbon dioxide (CO_2) and other greenhouse gases produced through daily activities. This helps reduce climate change and environmental pollution.

Key steps include:

- Using less energy (like switching off lights), using energy-saving appliances).
- Choosing eco-friendly transport (walking, cycling, public transit).
- Reducing waste by using less packaging and recycling.
- Eating more plant-based foods and fewer animal-based foods because animals like cows produce a lot of greenhouse gases.
- Supporting local products and sustainable businesses.

Benefits:

Such a lifestyle not only helps the environment by reducing pollution and slowing global warming, but also saves money, leads to better health (through more activity and fresher

foods), and builds stronger communities.

10. What is Mission LiFE?

Ans Mission LiFE stands for "Lifestyle for Environ-ment". It is an Indian campaign launched at the United Nations climate change conference (COP26) in Glasgow in November 2021 by the Central Pollution Control Board and introduced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The aim is to encourage people in India and across the world to follow eco-friendly and sustainable ~~practise~~ practices from 2022 to 2028.

This campaign urges individuals and communities to change their habits, reduce waste, and use resources wisely, drawing on traditional and cultural values for environmental protection.

11. Write a short note on Mission LiFE (Lifestyle for Environment).

Ans Mission LiFE is a major environmental movement led by India that encourages people to adopt environment-friendly lifestyles. Announced at COP26 in 2021, the mission has three main strategies:

- Individual Actions: Encouraging people to make small changes in daily life, like saving water and electricity.
- Industry and Market Response: Motivating businesses to supply eco-friendly goods and services. This pushes whole industries to become ecofriendly.

Policy Influence: leading governments to create rules and laws that support the use of clean energy, recycling, and sustainable living.

* Benefits of Mission LiFE:

- Raises mass awareness about sustainable living.
- Promotes collective efforts for environmental protection.
- Honors traditional sustainable habits.
- Supports the global fight against climate change.

12. Who introduced the term "sustainable development."?

Ans The term "sustainable development" became popular after it was used by the World ~~commission~~ commission on Environment and Development (also known as the ~~Brundtland~~ Brundtland commission), headed by Gro Harlem Brundtland. Their 1987 report - "Our common Future" - helped people worldwide understand the need to balance development with protecting resources for the future.

13. State fivewaays to bring changes in the lifestyle towards sustainability.

Ans Here are five ways -

1. Reduce, Reuse, Recycle - Buy only what you need, find new uses of for things, and recycle items instead of throwing them out.

2. Adopt Energy-Efficient Practices - Switch to energy-saving appliances, turn off lights when unnecessary, and use renewable sources like solar power.

3. Sustainable transportation - Walk, use a bicycle, or use public transport. carpool with others to reduce fuel use.

4. Support Sustainable Food Habits - Eat more vegetables and less meat, buy food from local farmers, and avoid wasting food.

5. Conserve Water - Use water-saving ~~features~~ fixtures, fix leaks quickly, and collect rainwater for gardening needs.